

BAYANIHAN

LINUX OS

The Philippines' Open Source Desktop Solution

ASTI — DOST, Philippines

Brief History

2001

Bayanihan Project launched by ASTI (Advanced Science & Technology Institute), under DOST (Department of Science and Technology) Philippines, as a pioneering open-source desktop initiative.

2003

Version 2 released in January; Version 3 Beta followed in October. Multiple beta iterations led to the final Bayanihan Linux 3 launch in February 2004.

2007

Bayanihan Linux 4 released, continuing to expand the distribution's reach in Philippine schools, government offices, and SMEs (Small and Medium sized Enterprises).

2011

Final release: Bayanihan Linux 5 Rev. 4 'Kalumbata', based on Debian with KDE 3.5, LibreOffice, and Firefox 4. Development has been inactive since.

Key Features

Complete OS Bundle

Word processor, spreadsheet, presentation software, email, browser & graphics editor — all in one install CD.

Free & Open Source

100% FOSS. Based on Debian Linux — zero licensing cost, ideal for budget-constrained schools and government.

LibreOffice Suite

Bundled with LibreOffice (v5.4+) for full office productivity — Writer, Calc, Impress, and more.

Mozilla Firefox

Ships with Mozilla Firefox as the default web browser for reliable and secure internet access.

KDE 3.5 Desktop

Familiar KDE desktop environment designed for ease of use, lowering the barrier for Linux newcomers.

Server Edition (BL Server)

Bayanihan also produced a server edition (Bayanihan Linux Thin Client Manager) alongside the desktop version for institutional use.

Interfaces

KDE 3.5 Desktop

- Primary desktop environment across all Bayanihan versions
- Taskbar, application launcher, system tray. familiar layout
- Konqueror file manager bundled alongside
- Customizable panels and window decorations

LibreOffice / OpenOffice.org

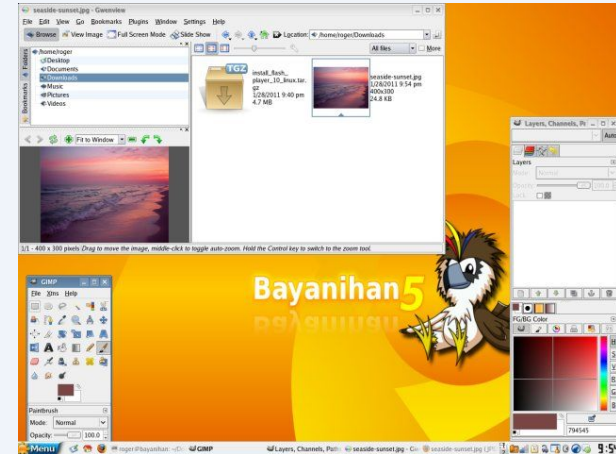
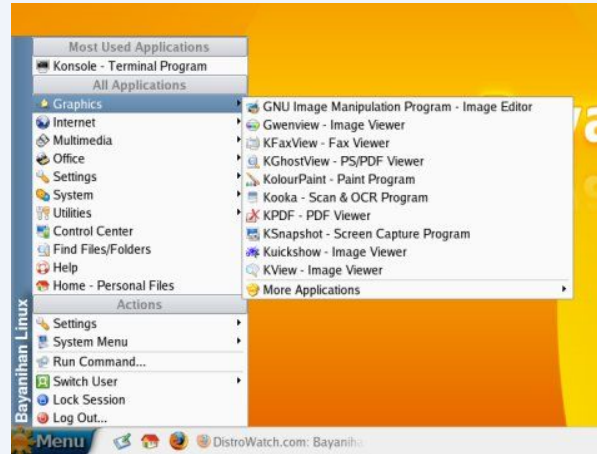
- Full GUI office suite for document creation
- Writer (word processing), Calc (spreadsheets), Impress (slides)
- Compatible with Microsoft Office file formats
- Both LibreOffice and OpenOffice.org 3.3 included in v5.4

Web & Communication

- Mozilla Firefox as the default web browser
- Konqueror also available as alternative browser
- Evolution Email client for email management
- Synaptic Package Manager for software updates

Interfaces

A live demonstration is better recommended.



Best For

Schools & Education

Designed with Philippine schools in mind — zero cost, bundled academic tools, easy for students and teachers.

Government Agencies

Promoted by Advanced Science and Technology Institute (ASTI) under the Department of Science and Technology (DOST) for government use, reducing dependence on proprietary licensed software.

SMEs (Small & Medium Enterprises)

Businesses needing a fully capable office suite without software licensing expenses.

FOSS Enthusiasts

Those interested in promoting and studying Free/Open Source Software in the Philippine context.

Legacy Hardware

Light enough for older x86 machines — suitable for re-purposing aging desktops in resource-limited settings.

Is It Better Than Other OS?

Claimed Advantages

- Completely free — no licensing costs whatsoever
- Localized for Philippine government & education needs
- Debian-based: inherits a stable, proven foundation
- Full office suite included out of the box
- Promotes Filipino tech sovereignty and FOSS culture

Honest Drawbacks

- Abandoned since 2011 — no security updates at all
- KDE 3.5 is severely outdated; most modern software won't run
- Very slow regional-only servers, no mirrors available
- Buggy software configs reported (notably the antivirus)
- Essentially zero community support or documentation online
- Any other Linux distro offers a far superior experience today

Verdict: Historically significant as a Filipino FOSS milestone, but not competitive with modern distributions.

Should You Use It?

Probably not — unless you have a very specific reason.

YES Historical curiosity — studying early Filipino FOSS (Free and Open Source Software) contributions

YES Demonstrating open-source desktop Linux to total beginners on legacy hardware

YES Academic research on national Linux distributions in Southeast Asia

NO General daily use — it's been unsupported since 2011

NO Security-sensitive environments — zero patches in over a decade

NO Modern hardware — KDE 3.5 struggles with contemporary systems

NO Productivity work — use Ubuntu, Fedora, or Linux Mint instead

For modern needs, use an actively maintained distro. Bayanihan's legacy is its spirit — not its software.